

Students

Suicide and Depression Awareness and Prevention

Youth suicide impacts the safety of the school environment. It also affects the school community, diminishing the ability of surviving students to learn and the school's ability to educate. Suicide and depression awareness and prevention are important Board goals.

Suicide and Depression Awareness and Prevention Program

The Superintendent or designee shall develop, implement, and maintain a suicide and depression awareness and prevention program (Program) that advances the Board's goals of increasing awareness and prevention of depression and suicide. This program must be consistent with the requirements of *Ann Marie's Law* listed below; each listed requirement, 1-6, corresponds with the list of required policy components in the School Code Section 5/2-3.166(c)(2)-(7). The Program shall include:

1. Protocols for administering youth suicide awareness and prevention education to students and staff.
 - a. For students, implementation will incorporate Board policy 6:60, *Curriculum Content*, which implements 105 ILCS 5/2-3.139 and 105 ILCS 5/27-7 (requiring education for students to develop a sound mind and a healthy body).
 - b. For staff, implementation will incorporate Board policy 5:100, *Staff Development Program*, and teacher's institutes under 105 ILCS 5/3-14.8 (requiring coverage of the warning signs of suicidal behavior).
2. Procedures for methods of suicide prevention with the goal of early identification and referral of students possibly at risk of suicide. Implementation will incorporate:
 - a. The training required by 105 ILCS 5/10-22.39 for licensed school personnel and administrators who work with students to identify the warning signs of suicidal behavior in youth along with appropriate intervention and referral techniques, including methods of prevention, procedures for early identification, and referral of students at risk of suicide; and
 - b. Ill. State Board of Education (ISBE)-recommended guidelines and educational materials for staff training and professional development, along with ISBE-recommended resources for students containing age-appropriate educational materials on youth suicide and awareness, if available pursuant to *Ann Marie's Law* on ISBE's website.
3. Methods of intervention, including procedures that address an emotional or mental health safety plan for use during the school day and at school-sponsored events for a student identified as being at increased risk of suicide including those students who: (A) suffer from a mental health disorder; (B) suffer from a substance abuse disorder; (C) engage in self-harm or have previously attempted suicide; (D) reside in an out-of-home placement; (E) are experiencing homelessness; (F) are lesbian, gay, bisexual, transgender, or questioning (LGBTQ); (G) are bereaved by suicide; or (H) have a medical condition or certain types of disabilities. Implementation will incorporate paragraph number 2, above, along with Board policies:

- a. 6:65, *Student Social and Emotional Development*, implementing the goals and benchmarks of the Ill. Learning Standards and 405 ILCS 49/15(b) (requiring student social and emotional development in the District's educational program);
 - b. 6:120, *Education of Children with Disabilities*, implementing special education requirements for the District;
 - c. 6:140, *Education of Homeless Children*, implementing provision of District services to students who are homeless;
 - d. 6:270, *Guidance and Counseling Program*, implementing guidance and counseling program(s) for students, and 105 ILCS 5/10-22.24a and 22.24b, which allow a qualified guidance specialist or any licensed staff member to provide school counseling services;
 - e. 7:10, *Equal Educational Opportunities*, and its implementing administrative procedure and exhibit, implementing supports for equal educational opportunities for students who are LGBTQ;
 - f. 7:50, *School Admissions and Student Transfers To and From Non-District Schools*, implementing State law requirements related to students who are in foster care;
 - g. 7:250, *Student Support Services*, implementing the Children's Mental Health Act, 405 ILCS 49/ (requiring protocols for responding to students with social, emotional, or mental health issues that impact learning ability); and
 - h. State and/or federal resources that address emotional or mental health safety plans for students who are possibly at an increased risk for suicide, if available on the ISBE's website pursuant to *Ann Marie's Law*.
4. Methods of responding to a student or staff suicide or suicide attempt. Implementation of this requirement shall incorporate building-level Student Support Committee(s) established through Board policy 7:250, *Student Support Services*.
 5. Reporting procedures. Implementation of this requirement shall incorporate Board policy 6:270, *Guidance and Counseling Program*, and Board policy 7:250, *Student Support Services*, in addition to other State and/or federal resources that address reporting procedures.
 6. A process to incorporate ISBE-recommended resources on youth suicide awareness and prevention programs, including current contact information for such programs in the District's Suicide and Depression Awareness and Prevention Program.

Illinois Suicide Prevention Strategic Planning Committee

The Superintendent or designee shall attempt to develop a relationship between the District and the Illinois Suicide Prevention Strategic Planning Committee, the Illinois Suicide Prevention Coalition Alliance, and/or a community mental health agency. The purpose of the relationship is to discuss how to incorporate the goals and objectives of the Illinois Suicide Prevention Strategic Plan into the District's Suicide Prevention and Depression Awareness Program.

Monitoring

The Board will review and update this policy pursuant to *Ann Marie's Law* and Board policy 2:240, *Board Policy Development*.

Information to Staff, Parents/Guardians, and Students

The Superintendent shall inform each school district employee about this policy and ensure its posting on the District's website. The Superintendent or designee shall provide a copy of this policy

to the parent or legal guardian of each student enrolled in the District. Student identification (ID) cards, the District's website, and student handbooks and planners will contain the support information as required by State law.

Implementation

This policy shall be implemented in a manner consistent with State and federal laws, including the Student Confidential Reporting Act, 5 ILCS 860/, Children's Mental Health Act, 405 ILCS 49/, Mental Health and Developmental Disabilities Confidentiality Act, 740 ILCS 110/, and the Individuals with Disabilities Education Act, 42 U.S.C. §12101 et seq.

The District, Board, and its staff are protected from liability by the Local Governmental and Governmental Employees Tort Immunity Act. Services provided pursuant to this policy: (1) do not replace the care of a physician licensed to practice medicine in all of its branches or a licensed medical practitioner or professional trained in suicide prevention, assessments and counseling services, (2) are strictly limited to the available resources within the District, (3) do not extend beyond the school day and/or school-sponsored events, and (4) cannot guarantee or ensure the safety of a student or the student body.

LEGAL REF.: 42 U.S.C. § 12101 et seq. Individuals with Disabilities Education Act.
105 ILCS 5/2-3.166, 105 ILCS 5/2-3.139, 5/3-14.8, 5/10-20.76, 5/10-20.81, 5/10-22.24a, 5/10-22.24b, 5/10-22.39, 5/14-1.01 et seq., 5/14-7.02, and 5/14-7.02b, 5/27-7.
5 ILCS 860/, Student Confidential Reporting Act.
405 ILCS 49/, Children's Mental Health Act.
740 ILCS 110/, Mental Health and Developmental Disabilities Confidentiality Act.
745 ILCS 10/, Local Governmental and Governmental Tort Immunity Act.

CROSS REF.: 2:240 (Board Policy Development), 5:100 (Staff Development Program), 6:60 (Curriculum Content), 6:65 (Student Social and Emotional Development), 6:120 (Education of Children with Disabilities), 6:270 (Guidance and Counseling Program), 7:180 (Prevention of and Response to Bullying, Intimidation, and Harassment), 7:250 (Student Support Services)

Students

Administrative Procedure - Resource Guide for Implementation of Suicide and Depression Awareness and Prevention Program

The Superintendent or designee, at the District level, and the Building Principal or designee, at the building level, are responsible for implementing the Board's goals of increasing awareness and prevention of depression and suicide in Policy 7:290, *Suicide and Depression Awareness and Prevention*. The Superintendent and/or Building Principal(s) may want to assign Student Support Committees as established under 7:250-AP2, *Protocol for Responding to Students with Social, Emotional, or Mental Health Needs*, to assist them with the implementation of these goals. Use other locally available resources, including, but not limited to those listed below to determine the best implementation methods.

Listed below are the six policy implementation components of *Ann Marie's Law*, 105 ILCS 5/2-3.166(c), in Board policy 7:290, *Suicide and Depression Awareness and Prevention*. Each component lists specific implementation steps, along with any applicable sample **PRESS** policies, administrative procedures and/or exhibits, available State and/or federal resources, and examples if available. The Ill. State Board of Education (ISBE) has created the *Illinois Youth Suicide Prevention Toolkit: A Reference for Administrators, Counselors, Teachers, and Staff*, at: www.isbe.net/Pages/Suicide-Prevention.aspx, and provides other resources at the same website to guide the District in the implementation of policy 7:290, *Suicide and Depression Awareness and Prevention*.

Confirm the resources listed in this procedure, and any information provided in the hyperlinks, with the Board Attorney before the Superintendent, Building Principal, and/or Student Support Committees apply them to a specific situation in the District.

Policy Implementation Components of Ann Marie's Law

1. Awareness and Prevention Education Protocols for Students and Staff (105 ILCS 5/2-3.166(c)(2)).
 - a. For students, (i) review policy 6:60, *Curriculum Content*(requiring health education for developing a sound mind and a healthy body); (ii) review policy 7:250, *Student Support Services* (requiring protocols for responding to students with social, emotional, or mental health issues that impact learning ability); (iii) if the District issues identification (ID) cards to its students, insert the contact information for the National Suicide Prevention Lifeline (NSPL) and for the Crisis Text Line (CTL) on the back of each student ID card (105 ILCS 5/10-20.76, added by P.A. 102-134 and renumbered by P.A. 102-813); (iv) publish NSPL and CTL information on the District's website (see 2:250-E2, *Immediately Available District Public Records and Web-Posted Reports and Records*) (105 ILCS 5/10-20.73, added by P.A. 102-134); (v) insert either the Safe2Help Illinois helpline or a local suicide prevention hotline or both on the ID card and identify each helpline that may be contacted through text messaging (105 ILCS 5/10-20.81, added by P.A. 102-416 and renumbered by P.A. 102-813); and (vi) include Safe2Help or local suicide prevention hotline or both in student handbooks and student planners (if a student planner is custom printed by the District or its schools for distribution to students in any of grades 6 through 12) (105 ILCS 5/10-20.81, added by P.A. 102-416 and renumbered by P.A. 102-813)). *Illinois Youth Suicide Prevention Toolkit: A Reference for Administrators, Counselors, Teachers and Staff, Module 1: Prevention - Engaging and Educating Students*, pp. 20-21, at: www.isbe.net/Pages/Suicide-Prevention.aspx. See also Illinois' Safe2Help Illinois program at: www.safe2helpil.com/ (designed to offer students a safe, confidential way to

share information that might help prevent suicides and other school safety-related information).

- b. For staff, review policy 5:100, *Staff Development Program*, discussing in-service training and citing required teacher institute training concerning the warning signs of suicidal behavior, and assess incorporating information from the following resources:

Illinois Youth Suicide Prevention Toolkit: A Reference for Administrators, Counselors, Teachers and Staff, Module 1: Prevention – Professional Learning Opportunities for Staff and Choosing a Preventative Training Program for Staff, pp. 18-19, at: www.isbe.net/Pages/Suicide-Prevention.aspx

Preventing Suicide: A Toolkit for High Schools (SAMHSA Toolkit), Chapter 4: Staff Education and Training including Tools, pp. 111 through 123 at: www.store.samhsa.gov/product/Preventing-Suicide-A-Toolkit-for-High-Schools/SMA12-4669.

2. Methods of Prevention, Early Identification, and Referral (105 ILCS 5/2-3.166(c)(3)).

- a. For staff, review: policy 5:100, *Staff Development Program*, discussing required behavioral training for school personnel; policy 6:60, *Curriculum Content* (see above for description); 7:250, *Student Support Services* (see above for description); and administrative procedure 7:250-AP2, *Protocol for Responding to Students with Social, Emotional, or Mental Health Needs*, establishing Student Support Committees to identify, prevent, and refer students with mental health challenges for services.

- b. For staff, assess incorporating information from the following resources:

Illinois Youth Suicide Prevention Toolkit: A Reference for Administrators, Counselors, Teachers and Staff, Module 2: Intervention, Procedure: Students at Risk, pp. 26-27, at: www.isbe.net/Pages/Suicide-Prevention.aspx.

SAMHSA Toolkit at: www.store.samhsa.gov/product/Preventing-Suicide-A-Toolkit-for-High-Schools/SMA12-4669.

Chapter 1: Getting Started pp. 15-22; Tool 1.A, Suicide Prevention: Facts for Schools, p. 24; and Tools 1.D-1.H, pp. 32-51 (includes various youth suicide prevention topics).

Chapter 4: Staff Education and Training including Tools, pp. 111-123.

Chapter 7: Screening, and Resources: Staff Education and Screening including Tools, pp. 157-171.

ISBE *Suicide Prevention* at: www.isbe.net/Pages/Suicide-Prevention.aspx.

Illinois Suicide Prevention Strategic Plan at: www.dph.illinois.gov/topics-services/prevention-wellness/suicide-prevention.

Sample policy (procedures) on youth suicide prevention are available from The Trevor Project at: www.thetrevorproject.org/pages/modelschoolpolicy

Risk and Protective Factors for Suicide available at: www.isbe.net/Pages/Suicide-Prevention.aspx.
sprc.org/about-suicide/risk-protective-factors.

- c. Review and train staff on appropriate identification procedures (see example below):

Identification of the At-Risk Student

Note: A more detailed procedure may be developed with the aid of the resources in 2.b., above.

- 1) An employee having any reason to believe a student is considering or threatening suicide is to contact the Building Principal and District social worker/counselor.
 - 2) The social worker/counselor or Building Principal will meet with the student.
 - 3) The social worker/counselor will call the student's parent(s)/guardian(s) and arrange a meeting. All calls and meetings with parent(s)/guardian(s) will be documented and a copy of the documentation sent by certified mail to the parent(s)/guardian(s).
 - 4) The social worker/counselor will suggest to the parent(s)/guardian(s) that the State or community mental health agency be contacted. This suggestion shall be a part of the documentation sent to the parent(s)/guardian(s). A student should never be left alone if an employee reasonably believes the student is in imminent risk of suicide. An employee should immediately contact the student's parent(s)/guardian(s).
3. Methods of Intervention; Emotional or Mental Health Safety Plans for At-Risk Students, including those students who suffer from a mental health disorder; suffer from a substance abuse disorder; engage in self-harm or have previously attempted suicide; reside in an out-of-home placement; are experiencing homelessness; are lesbian, gay, bisexual, transgender, or questioning (LGBTQ); are bereaved by suicide; or have a medical condition or certain types of disabilities. 105 ILCS 5/2-3.166(c)(4), amended by P.A. 102-267.
- a. Review policies 6:65, *Student Social and Emotional Development*, incorporating student social and emotional development into the District's educational program as required by the goals and benchmarks of the Ill. Learning Standards and 405 ILCS 49/15(b); policy 6:270, *Guidance and Counseling Program*, requiring the District to have guidance counseling available to implement the protocols directed in 7:250, *Student Support Services*; and administrative procedure 7:250-AP2, *Protocol for Responding to Students with Social, Emotional, or Mental Health Needs*, requiring protocols for responding to students with social, emotional, or mental health needs that impact learning ability as required by the Children's Mental Health Act, 405 ILCS 49/, amended by P.A. 102-899, eff. 1-1-23.
 - b. Train staff pursuant to 105 ILCS 5/10-22.24b, which allows school counseling services to be used for suicide issues and intervention.
 - c. Assess incorporating information from the following resources:

Illinois Youth Suicide Prevention Toolkit: A Reference for Administrators, Counselors, Teachers and Staff, Module 2: Intervention - Procedure: Responding to a Student Displaying Warning Signs or Student Suicide Attempt, pp. 27-29, and *Guidelines: Modifying Intervention Protocols - Crafting a Protocol for Helping Students at Risk*, pp. 30-31, at: www.isbe.net/Pages/Suicide-Prevention.aspx.

SAMHSA Toolkit at: www.store.samhsa.gov/product/Preventing-Suicide-A-Toolkit-for-High-Schools/SMA12-4669.

Chapter 2: Protocols for Helping Students at Risk of Suicide, pp. 57-66 and Tools 2.A-2.B.2, pp. 68-72.

Chapter 6: Student Programs including Tools, pp. 139-156.

Resources: Getting Started, pp. 177-182; Staff Education and Training, pp. 186-192; and Student Education and Skill-Building, pp. 194-204.

Illinois Suicide Prevention Strategic Plan at:

www.dph.illinois.gov/topics-services/prevention-wellness/suicide-prevention.

Cyberbullying Research Center, available at:

<https://cyberbullying.org/>.

U.S. School Safety Clearinghouse website at:

www.schoolsafety.gov/, discussed in f/n 1, para. 3 of policy 4:170, *Safety*.

4. Methods of Responding to a Suicide Attempt (105 ILCS 5/2-3.166(c)(5)).

a. Review policies listed above in number 3.a.

b. Assess incorporating information from the following resources:

Illinois Youth Suicide Prevention Toolkit: A Reference for Administrators, Counselors, Teachers and Staff, Module 2: Guidelines: Modifying Intervention Protocols - Crafting a Protocol for Helping Students at Risk, pp. 30-31, and *Module 3: Postvention, Procedure: Responding to a Completed Student Suicide*, pp. 36-39, at: www.isbe.net/Pages/Suicide-Prevention.aspx.

SAMHSA Toolkit at: www.store.samhsa.gov/product/Preventing-Suicide-A-Toolkit-for-High-Schools/SMA12-4669.

Chapter 3: After a Suicide including Tools, pp. 92-109. (some material adaptable to a suicide attempt)

Resources: Crisis Response Postvention, pp. 182-185.

After a Suicide: A Toolkit for Schools (ISBE Toolkit) at:

www.sprc.org/sites/default/files/migrate/library/AfteraSuicideToolkitforSchools.pdf.

(some material adaptable to a suicide attempt)

5. Reporting Procedures (105 ILCS 5/2-3.166(c)(6)).

a. Review policy 6:270, *Guidance and Counseling Program*, providing a counseling program that the Superintendent may designate as responsible for development of the District's depression awareness and suicide prevention program procedures; policy 7:250, *Student Support Services*, identifying District support services that will be ultimately responsible for properly implementing the reporting procedures; and administrative procedure 7:250-AP2, *Protocol for Responding to Students with Social, Emotional, or Mental Health Needs*, establishing Student Support Committees for purposes of identifying, preventing and referring for services students with mental health needs.

b. Assess incorporating information from the following resources:

Illinois Youth Suicide Prevention Toolkit: A Reference for Administrators, Counselors, Teachers and Staff, Module 2: Guidelines: Modifying Intervention Protocols - Crafting a Procedure for Students Exhibiting Warning Signs and for a Student Suicide, pp. 31-34, at: www.isbe.net/Pages/Suicide-Prevention.aspx.

SAMHSA Toolkit at: www.store.samhsa.gov/product/Preventing-Suicide-A-Toolkit-for-High-Schools/SMA12-4669.

Chapter 2: Protocols for Helping Students at Risk of Suicide: Tools 2.B.3-6 (pp. 70-72), 2.C (p. 79) and 2.D (pp. 70-81).

c. Review appropriate identification procedures (see example below):

Documentation Regarding the At-Risk Student

Note: A more detailed procedure may be developed with the aid of the resources in 5.b., above.

- 1) District employees shall take notes on any conversations that involve or relate to the at-risk student. The notes shall become a part of a written report to the Building Principal.
 - 2) Conversations that involve or relate to the at-risk student shall be confirmed in writing with the other party(s).
 - 3) The Superintendent shall receive a copy of all reports and documentation regarding the at-risk student.
 - 4) The social worker/counselor shall prepare a report of the situation for the student's records.
- d. Provide training for staff regarding identification procedures that the District will implement.
6. Resources and Contact Information (105 ILCS 5/2-3.166(c)(7)).
- a. Illinois suicide prevention organizations and State contacts at: www.sprc.org/states/illinois:
Jennifer L. Martin, Injury Prevention Coordinator (at time of publication)
535 West Jefferson, 2nd Floor
Springfield, IL 62761
Jennifer.L.Martin@illinois.gov
(217) 558-4081

Steve Moore, J.D., Co-Chair, Illinois Suicide Prevention Alliance Board member (at time of publication)
Smoore200400@yahoo.com
(312) 391-8056
 - b. Primary implementation resources for 7:290-AP, *Resource Guide for Implementation of Suicide and Depression Awareness and Prevention Program*:
Illinois Youth Suicide Prevention Toolkit: A Reference for Administrators, Counselors, Teachers and Staff, at: www.isbe.net/Pages/Suicide-Prevention.aspx.
SAMHSA Toolkit: Chapter 1: Getting Started; Tools 1.I and 1.J., pp. 52-53.
Resources: Screening Program, p. 205; and National Organization and Federal Agencies with Resource and Information on Adolescent Suicide Prevention, pp. 206-208.
ISBE *Toolkit* at:
www.sprc.org/sites/default/files/migrate/library/AfteraSuicideToolkitforSchools.pdf.
ISBE *Suicide Prevention* at: www.isbe.net/Pages/Suicide-Prevention.aspx.
ISBE recommended guidelines and educational materials for training and professional development and ISBE-recommended resources containing age-appropriate educational materials on youth suicide and awareness, if available on ISBE's website pursuant to Ann Marie's Law (105 ILCS 5/2-3.166(b)(2)(B)).
Illinois Suicide Prevention Strategic Plan at:
www.dph.illinois.gov/topics-services/prevention-wellness/suicide-prevention.
 - c. Other available resources:
American Foundation for Suicide Prevention, Illinois Chapter at:
www.afsp.org/chapter/afsp-illinois/.

The Ill. Department of Human Services is required by 20 ILCS 1705/76 to develop an online database of mental health resources geared toward school counselors, parents, and teachers at: www.dhs.state.il.us/page.aspx?item=29751.

National Suicide Prevention Lifeline at: www.suicidepreventionlifeline.org/.

Sexual Orientation, Gender Identity and Youth Suicide at: www.dph.illinois.gov/topics-services/prevention-wellness/suicide-prevention.html#resources.

The Suicide Prevention Resource Center (SPRC) (www.sprc.org/) has an Illinois-specific site at: www.sprc.org/states/illinois.